

LEAVES



Leaves work very hard for plants. They make food, and they also help plants to cope with serious problems like how to survive the cold or get enough water. Leaves come in all sorts of shapes and sizes—large and small, thick and thin. In fact, you can tell quite a lot about a plant and where it grows just by looking at its leaves.

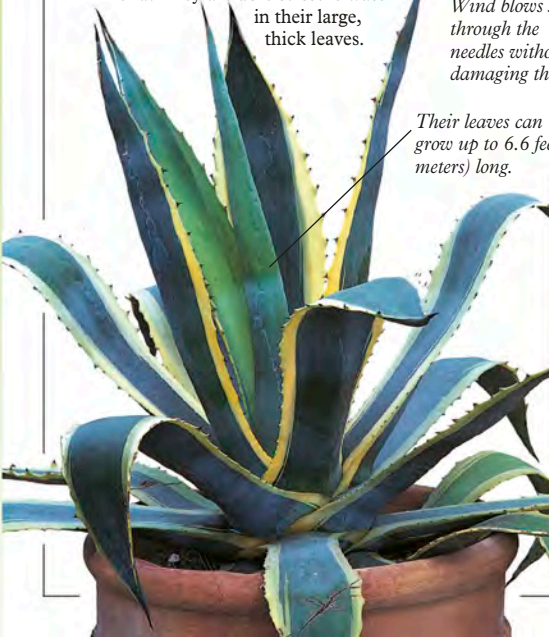
Water store

Agave plants grow in hot places where it may not rain for weeks on end. They are able to store water

in their large, thick leaves.



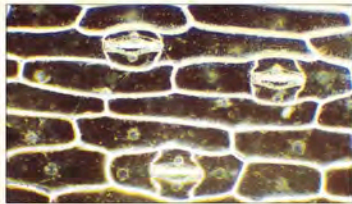
Wind blows through the needles without damaging them.



Their leaves can grow up to 6.6 feet (two meters) long.

Weatherproof

Scots pine trees need to be tough to survive long, cold winters. They have thousands of tiny, needlelike leaves. The needles have a waterproof coating to protect them from rain and snow.



Open sesame

Leaves have tiny holes called stomata, which the plant can open and close. When the stomata are open, they let air in and out, and water out. When they are closed, water can't escape from the leaves.